Why are women not empowered?

They lack four basic things:

(i) Knowledge

(ii) Finance

(iii) Power

(iv) Opportunity

Role of Self Help Groups in Empowerment of Rural Women

Women in India are victims of a multiple socio-economic and cultural factors. They are an integral part of every economy. All round development and harmonious growth of a nation would be possible only when women are considered as equal partners in progress with men.

Rapid progress in SHG formation has now turned into an empowerment movement among women across the country.

Six ways through which women SHGs empower rural women

- Make rural women aware of their basic rights
- Help rural women in getting employment
- Raise self-confidence and enhance social status
- Increase community participation of the rural women
- Spread awareness about start ups-food processing units.
- Motivate taking up social responsibilities related to women development.

DO YOU KNOW?

STEP: Support to Training and Employment Programme for women (1986-87)

STEP was launched by the Government of India's Ministry of Women and Child Development to train women with no access to formal skill training facilities especially in rural India (Agriculture, horticulture, food processing, handlooms, embroidery etc.)

9.4.3 Government Schemes

Monetary funds are one of the foremost requirements for any business setup and operation. Government schemes help the Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) to finance their day-to-day expenses, growth and expansion. All public sector banks work with the government organizations / institutes to provide sponsored loans for small business. They are:

1. The Credit Guarantee Fund Scheme for Micro and Small Enterprises (CGS)
2. Small Industries Development Bank of India Loan for Small Enterprises (SMILE)
3. Credit Link Capital Subsidy Scheme for Technology upgradation
4. National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
5. National Small Industries Corporation Limited (NSIC)
6. Mini Tools Rooms and Training Centre Scheme

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